

AA-12

Management Summary

The programme in plain language, for readers who will not open the other twelve

30 August 2026 · Rev 1.0 — baseline · AA-12 of thirteen

WHAT IS BUILT

three portals

SCREENS

91

PEOPLE ASKED FOR

4 engineers

CALENDAR

10 weeks

RECURRING COST

Rs 0

REAL MONTHLY COST

₹67

This is the short version, written for someone who will read it and nothing else. It says what is being built, what a customer and a business partner will actually experience, what it costs, why the handling of personal data and money can be trusted, and what could go wrong. It contains no code, no technical vocabulary that is not explained where it appears, and no claim that is not repeated in more detail somewhere in the twelve documents behind it. Where a number appears here it is the same number as in the plan it came from, because this document is generated from the same source. AA-10 has the week-by-week schedule and the full list of risks; AA-00 has the shape of the system. Nothing else needs to be read to follow this.

12.1 WHAT IS BEING BUILT, AND WHY		
Three self-service websites replacing work that only an employee can do today		
WHAT IS BEING BUILT three portals one for staff, one for suppliers, one for couriers	SCREENS IN TOTAL 91 41 staff, 26 supplier, 24 courier	PEOPLE ASKED FOR 4 engineers one of the four is not hired yet
CALENDAR 10 weeks a small live trial sits inside the last week	RECURRING COST Rs 0 no new monthly bill of any kind	REAL MONTHLY COST ₹67 the domain name, already being paid

Atavishaala sells farm supplies. Today, every single thing a new business partner needs in order to start trading on the platform is done by an Atavishaala employee, by hand. A new supplier is signed up by an employee, its documents are checked by an employee, its products are typed into the catalogue by an employee, and when an order arrives that supplier is telephoned or messaged by an employee. A new delivery company is signed up the same way, told about each parcel the same way, and paid by an employee working out the arithmetic in a spreadsheet. None of this is anybody doing a bad job. It is simply that the work grows in direct proportion to the number of suppliers and the number of deliveries, and there is only so much of it one person can carry.

That employee is therefore the ceiling on growth. Doubling the number of suppliers means roughly doubling that workload, and the same is true of doubling deliveries. The business can buy its way past the ceiling by hiring more coordinators, which raises the cost of every order and never stops rising, or it can give the outside parties the tools to do their own part of the work. This programme is the second option.

Staff portal

41 screens. Atavishaala employees: exceptions, approvals, money, and the crop-advice desk

Supplier portal

26 screens. A product company signs itself up, lists its own goods, packs its own orders

Courier portal

24 screens. A delivery company takes jobs, sends its riders, proves delivery

▼ all three are windows onto one system; none of them holds its own copy of the data

One backend system

the single place where anything is stored, checked or decided, and the only thing that touches the database

Three separate websites are built on top of one existing system. Staff get a proper internal console in place of the founder-only tool used today. A product company gets a website where it registers itself, uploads its licences, lists its own products for approval, and then sees and packs the orders that belong to it. A delivery company gets a website where it is offered parcels to carry, allocates its own riders, and records each delivery as it happens. Each of the three can only see its own data, and none of them can reach anything else.

Every one of those three replaces a specific conversation that an employee has today. Signing up a supplier stops being an exchange of emails and becomes a form that supplier fills in. Listing a product stops being an employee typing from a photograph and becomes something the supplier submits and a member of staff approves or rejects with a reason. Telling a delivery company that a parcel is ready stops being a phone call and becomes an offer that appears on their screen. Working out what to pay them stops being a spreadsheet and becomes a weekly figure the system has already added up.

Stated in one sentence: this is a change to how Atavishaala operates, delivered as software, and not a set of new features. The measurable outcome is not a screen count. It is that the number of suppliers and the number of deliveries the business can carry stops being limited by how many people it employs to coordinate them.

WHAT THIS DOCUMENT DELIBERATELY DOES NOT DO

It does not ask you to evaluate any technical choice, because none of them is yours to make. It does not repeat the schedule week by week; that is AA-10, and this document is generated from the same figures so the two cannot disagree. Everything below is either something a customer or a partner will experience, something it costs, something that protects the business, or something that could go wrong.

12.2 WHAT A CUSTOMER AND A PARTNER ACTUALLY EXPERIENCE

One order, from the basket to the money, in ordinary language

The clearest way to describe what changes is to follow a single order. A customer fills one basket with two things that come from two different companies: a bag of seed from one supplier and a hand sprayer from another. She pays once, for the whole basket, and as far as she is concerned she has placed one order. Behind that single order the system creates two shipments. A shipment is one parcel from one supplier, and it is the unit that everything afterwards is organised around, because two suppliers in two towns cannot put their goods in the same box.

1. The order splits. The seed supplier is shown one shipment and the sprayer supplier is shown the other. Neither can see the other exists, and neither sees anything about the order except what it has to pack.
2. Each supplier accepts its own shipment on its own screen, packs it, and prints its own label. No Atavishaala employee telephones anybody to make this happen.
3. A packed shipment is offered to the delivery companies whose service area covers that address. They all see the offer at the same time and the first one to accept it gets the job; the offer then disappears for the others. If nobody accepts inside the waiting period, the job falls to an internal delivery team that Atavishaala staff operate themselves, so a parcel is never stranded because the market declined it.
4. The delivery company allocates one of its own riders. That rider is given the delivery address for that one job only, and only for a limited period around the delivery.
5. At the door the customer reads out a short one-time code, which the rider types in. That code, a photograph and a single location reading are the proof that the parcel was handed to the right person. If it is a cash-on-delivery order, the cash the rider collects is recorded against him at the same moment.
6. Money moves on its own. As soon as delivery is proven, the amount owed to that supplier and the fee owed to that delivery company are recorded. On a fixed day each week the system produces one figure per partner, and a member of staff approves the bank transfer against it. Nobody adds anything up in a spreadsheet.

The customer gets four things she did not have. She can see each parcel of a mixed order moving on its own, rather than one order status that means nothing once the parcels separate. She gets a delivery code, so a parcel cannot quietly be left with the wrong person and later disputed. She can raise a return on one item without unpicking the rest of the basket. And she can ask a crop question and have it answered by an Atavishaala agronomist through the same account, which is the part of the offer a general marketplace cannot copy.

There is one thing she will not get, and it is worth naming plainly rather than discovering in a support ticket: there is no live map with a rider moving across it. Continuous location reporting and map imagery are both billed by usage, and this programme is built with no monthly budget at all, so the honest choice is to leave it out rather than to switch it on and then be unable to pay for it as volume grows. What she gets instead is the set of milestones that matter — packed, collected, out for delivery, delivered — and a delivery window. Live tracking is a purchase decision, and it is priced in section 12.3 alongside the other four things that are not free.

WHAT THE SUPPLIER GETS

A place to register itself, upload its licences, list its own products for approval, price them, see only its own orders, pack them, and see what it will be paid this week and why. It never sees another supplier, and it never sees a customer phone number.

WHAT THE DELIVERY COMPANY GETS

Offers it can accept or decline on commercial terms it agreed in advance, its own riders to allocate, proof of delivery captured on the rider phone, cash-on-delivery collections tracked per rider, and one weekly figure it can check.

12.3 WHAT IT COSTS, AND WHAT RS 0 COSTS

No new monthly bill, paid for in engineer days and in some manual staff work

NEW RECURRING COST

Rs 0

per month, for all three portals

ACTUAL MONTHLY COST

₹67

the domain name, already being paid before this programme

PAID THINGS DEFERRED

5

each named below with its real price

The infrastructure position is unusual and it is worth being precise about it. Three new websites, the machinery that builds and publishes them, and three new web addresses together add nothing to the monthly bill. Every piece of it sits inside the free allowance of services the business already uses. The only money leaving the account is the domain name at about ₹67 a month, which was being paid before this programme started. The itemised budget in the plan behind this document has a zero on every other line.

That is a genuine result and it is also not free. It is paid for in two currencies other than cash. The first is engineer time: roughly six to seven days out of the 200 engineer-days in this plan are spent doing things the

cheap way rather than the quick way — keeping the running processes inside a free tier, writing the small pieces of plumbing a paid service would have supplied, and building reporting by hand instead of buying a reporting tool. The second is staff time, and this one matters more, because it compounds. Several of the things below are handled by a member of staff doing a small manual job, and a small manual job repeated per supplier or per delivery is exactly the kind of cost this programme exists to remove. At pilot volumes it is ten minutes a week. At ten times the volume it is a person.

WHAT IS NOT FREE	WHAT IS DONE INSTEAD	WHAT BUYING IT WOULD COST
Masked click-to-call between rider and customer	The rider is given the address for that one job, inside a time window, and every such release is recorded. Contact goes through a WhatsApp message, not a phone call.	Exotel or Kaleyra number masking, roughly ₹0.60/minute plus a ₹1 500/month platform fee.
Automated bank-account verification (penny drop)	A member of staff sends ₹1 by UPI and checks the account holder name matches. Ten minutes a week at pilot volumes.	Cashfree or Razorpay account validation, roughly ₹3 per verification.
Real-time rider GPS tracking on a map for the customer	Milestones and a delivery window instead of a moving dot. The proof of delivery still captures one location reading, which is all that is needed to show the parcel reached the right place.	Google Maps Platform beyond the \$200 monthly credit, plus a location ingest path.
SMS delivery notifications at scale	WhatsApp messages first and app notifications second. Text messages are used only as the fallback for login codes.	2Factor.in or MSG91 at roughly ₹0.18 per transactional SMS plus DLT fees.
A hosted BI or reporting layer over the portal data	Eleven fixed figures on one staff screen, refreshed continuously, plus an export for anything deeper. No reporting tool to log into.	Metabase Cloud from roughly \$85/month, or a small always-on VM.

READ THIS AS A PILOT-SCALE POSITION, NOT A PERMANENT ONE

Rs 0 per month is the right answer for a ten-week build and a small live trial, because it removes the one argument that could stop the programme before it has shown anything. It is not the right answer for a business doing real volume. A genuine growth quarter converts two or three of the five rows above into purchases — most likely the masked calling, the bank verification and the message sending — and the sums involved are small and predictable. What has been protected is the order of events: nothing has to be bought in order to find out whether suppliers and delivery companies will use this at all.

12.4 WHERE THE TRUST COMES FROM

Fewer people can see a customer, and no money record can be quietly changed

Opening a platform to outside companies means letting outsiders near customers and near money. The two decisions that follow are the ones a stakeholder should understand, because they are the reason this can be opened up at all.

The first is that nobody sees a customer in full. A customer name, telephone number and address are shown everywhere in the system as their last four characters only, and that is true of the supplier screens, the delivery-company screens and the Atavishaala staff screens alike. There is no button that reveals the rest, and there is no seniority that unlocks it: the most senior administrator account sees exactly what a junior support agent sees. This is not caution for its own sake. A complete customer list is the single most valuable thing a competitor could take out of this business, and the most common way such a list leaves a company is through an employee — pressured, bribed, careless or simply leaving. If no account in the system can display the list, then no account can be used to take it, and the question of trusting individual staff members with it never has to be asked.

There is exactly one exception, and it is deliberately narrow. A rider who is out delivering a specific parcel is given the delivery address for that parcel, because the parcel cannot otherwise arrive. That release is tied to one job, expires after a fixed window of a few hours around the delivery, and is written into a permanent record of who saw what and when, at the same instant the address is shown. The customer telephone number is not part of that exception and is never released to anyone — a rider who needs to reach the customer does so through a message the system sends on his behalf. The cost of this is real: it makes some support conversations slower than a phone call would be. That is the trade being made, and it is being made on purpose.

THE RULE	WHY IT IS WORTH THE INCONVENIENCE
Personal details are shown as the last four characters only, in every portal, for every role, with no way to reveal more	Removes the insider risk entirely rather than managing it, and shrinks any future data incident to something that cannot identify a customer. It also means a supplier or courier gaining access to their own account has gained access to nothing else.
One exception: a delivery address, to one rider, for one job, for a few hours, permanently recorded	The parcel has to arrive. Because every release is recorded, a dispute about a delivery can be answered from the record instead of from memory, and an unusual pattern of address lookups is visible rather than invisible.
Every movement of money is written once and never altered	A correction is added as a second, offsetting entry, so the original figure and the correction both survive. When a supplier or a delivery company disputes what it was paid, the whole arithmetic can be shown. Nobody can quietly edit what a partner is owed.
Every action a member of staff takes is recorded with what it changed	Approvals, rejections, price changes and payout releases all have a name and a time against them. This is what makes it safe to give staff the power to act quickly.
Staff sign in with an authenticator code as well as a password, and confirm it again before sensitive actions	The realistic attack on a back office is a stolen password, not a clever exploit. A second factor makes a stolen password useless on its own.

ONE THING IS MISSING ON PURPOSE: MONEY CANNOT BE TAKEN OUT OF THE PLATFORM

Customers and partners can hold credit — from a refund, a promotion or an unpaid balance — and can spend it on the platform. They cannot withdraw it to a bank account. That is not a feature waiting for a later release. Converting stored value back into cash makes the business a prepaid payment instrument issuer in the eyes of the Reserve Bank of India, which requires a licence, capital and an audit regime that a company of this size should not go anywhere near. Partner payouts are a different thing entirely and do go to bank accounts: they are a business paying its suppliers and its couriers what it owes them, weekly, against a figure the system has calculated and a member of staff has approved.

12.5 THE PLAN, THE RISKS AND THE HONEST UNCERTAINTIES

Ten weeks, four engineers, one of whom has not been hired

CALENDAR

10 weeks

consecutive, with no slack week anywhere in them

ENGINEER DAYS

200

4 engineers for 10 weeks

AGREED CUTS

20 days

about one calendar week of team capacity, and no more

The shape of the ten weeks is straightforward. The first three build the staff console, the permission system that decides who may do what, and the supplier side: a product company can be invited, submit its documents, be verified, and get its first product approved and visible to customers. Weeks four to seven are the difficult half and the part with the real risk in it — splitting an order into one parcel per supplier without disturbing the orders already live in the system, offering those parcels to delivery companies, proving delivery at the door, and then getting the weekly money right to the last rupee. Weeks eight and nine cover returns, the crop-advice desk, and hardening, which is the unglamorous work of making the thing safe to expose to strangers. Week ten is the pilot: two real product companies and one real delivery company transacting end to end, with the decision to continue taken on what that week actually shows.

Three things about this plan should be said without decoration. Week one matters far more than it looks, because what has to be finished in it is the shared set of building blocks all three websites are made from, and a delay there moves the end date by the same amount rather than being absorbed. Week four is the only change to data that already exists in production, and three later weeks stand on it. And weeks nine and ten cannot be compressed: hardening is a condition of going live, and the pilot involves outside companies with their own calendars.

The fourth engineer does not exist yet. Two backend engineers and one front-end engineer are already on the team; the second front-end engineer is a hire, and that person is meant to be working by week one and building supplier screens by week two. That one seat carries fifty of the 91 screens. There is no version of this plan in which the existing front-end engineer absorbs both halves, and the honest consequence of the hire not landing by the end of week two is fewer screens, not a longer week: the courier-facing website slips behind the supplier one and is run from staff screens in the interim, the whole cut list is taken, and the supplier website ships with the ten screens the pilot suppliers genuinely need. That is a decision worth agreeing now rather than in week five.

The four risks worth a stakeholder's attention

There are twelve risks in the register in AA-10 section 10.9, each with an owner, a trigger and a written response. Four of them score highest when likelihood is multiplied by consequence, and these are the four to ask about at a review. The other eight are engineering problems with engineering answers and they do not need this reader.

AA-10 REF	THE RISK	WHY IT MATTERS COMMERCIALY	WHAT HAPPENS IF IT FIRES
R-02	No independent delivery company signs up in time for the pilot	The courier-facing website is half the thesis. If no outside courier will take the commission on offer, the platform has automated its own delivery team and not opened a market.	The internal delivery team runs on the same screens, so every part of the system is still exercised and the pilot still happens — but the growth argument is unproven and the commission terms have to be reopened.
R-09	Cash collected at the door goes missing between the rider and the platform	Cash on delivery is how a large share of rural orders are paid. Money that a rider has collected and not handed in is a direct loss, and it is the loss that is hardest to reconstruct after the fact.	Every collection is recorded against a named rider at the moment of delivery and reconciled weekly, so a shortfall is visible in days rather than months. It is still recovered from a partner by conversation, not by software.
R-12	Ten weeks with four engineers is optimistic	The date is what everything else is planned around — the pilot companies, the staff training, the decision to continue.	The pre-agreed cut list of 8 items comes off, in a written order, without a meeting. It is worth about one week. Anything beyond that moves the date and must be said out loud rather than absorbed.
R-04	A rider genuinely needs to reach the customer, and not having the phone number blocks the delivery	This is the direct cost of the privacy position in section 12.4, and it lands on the one moment that decides whether a customer is satisfied.	The rider triggers a message to the customer through the system, and staff can bridge the call manually. If this proves to be a frequent failure, masked calling is the first of the five paid items in section 12.3 to buy.

On the cut list: 20 engineer-days are agreed in advance as removable, in a named order, so that a slipping week does not become a negotiation. Across 4 engineers that is 5 working days — one calendar week of team capacity and not a day more. It buys one week. It does not buy two. Anything that needs more than a week of relief is a change to the date or a change to what is delivered, and there is no third option hiding in the plan.

The three conditions under which stopping is the right decision

A programme of this size should say in advance how it ends badly, because the alternative is one that gets extended three times by people who each individually could not see a reason to stop. None of the three below is a failure of the software; the software will very probably work. They are failures of the assumption behind it — that suppliers want to do this themselves, that independent couriers want this commission, and that the automation removes more staff work than the free-of-charge workarounds create.

STOP IF	HOW IT IS MEASURED, AND WHEN IT BECOMES VISIBLE
The pilot suppliers do not use their portal	Fewer than half of a week's parcels are accepted, packed and handed over by a supplier rather than by staff doing it on the supplier's behalf, and fewer than five products are listed by a supplier in the first fortnight after go-live. Visible two weeks after the pilot.
Independent couriers will not accept the commission	Two or more delivery companies reach a rate conversation and decline, or acceptance of offered parcels stays below forty per cent with couriers taking more than eight minutes on average to respond. The declines are visible in week eight; the acceptance rate two weeks after the pilot.
The manual work created exceeds the staff work removed	Staff hours per week spent on the manual workarounds in section 12.3 and on clearing exceptions, measured against the hours the same people spent on manual onboarding and order coordination before week one. Visible four weeks after the pilot.

THE THIRD CONDITION CANNOT BE MEASURED UNLESS SOMEBODY WRITES A NUMBER DOWN IN WEEK ONE

The comparison is impossible without knowing how many hours a week staff currently spend onboarding suppliers, cataloguing products and coordinating multi-supplier orders by hand. That number is the entire justification for the programme, and it is not on anybody's task list. Record it in week one, or accept that the programme cannot be judged on the thing it was approved for. The second condition is the one most likely to fire and the one where stopping is least likely to be correct, which is exactly why it needs a written measurement rather than a judgement made in the moment.

12.6 WHERE TO GO NEXT

Thirteen documents, and who each of them was written for

This document is deliberately the shortest of the thirteen and the only one written for a reader who is not going to open the others. If a claim made here needs checking, the table below says which document to open. Two are worth naming directly: AA-00 explains the shape of the system and the fourteen rules that every part of it obeys, and AA-10 has the week-by-week schedule, all twelve risks and the cut list. Everything in this summary is generated from the same underlying figures as those two, which is why the numbers cannot drift apart.

ID	DOCUMENT	WHAT IS IN IT	WHO IT IS FOR
AA-00	Programme Charter & Architecture Overview	Why three portals, what each one is, and the fourteen invariants that bind them	Anyone who wants the shape of the whole thing. Start here after this document.
AA-01	Repository Topology, CI/CD & the Shared Portal Kit	Five repositories, their boundaries, pipelines, and the versioned kit between them	Engineers. How the code is organised and published.
AA-02	Backend Extension: Modules, Namespaces & Tenancy	Eleven modules, four API namespaces, and how tenant scope is made unforgeable	Engineers. How one supplier is prevented from reaching another supplier's data.
AA-03	Data Model & Migration Plan	Thirty-six new tables, the shipment split, and eight ordered migrations	Engineers. What is stored, and the one risky change to existing data.
AA-04	API Contract Reference	Every admin, partner and fleet endpoint at freeze, with scope and idempotency	Engineers, and anyone integrating with the platform later.
AA-05	Admin Portal Specification	Forty-one screens for internal staff, plus the agronomist Advisor console	Operations and support staff. What the internal console will do.
AA-06	Supplier Portal Specification	Twenty-six screens for product companies: catalog, shipments, returns, payouts	Whoever will train and support the supplier companies.
AA-07	Fleet Portal Specification	Twenty-four screens for delivery companies: offers, riders, POD, COD remittance	Whoever will negotiate with and support the delivery companies.
AA-08	Identity, Permissions, PII & Security Charter	Four actor classes, eighty-eight permissions, and the last-four-only disclosure regime	Read this if you have a question about privacy, access or security.
AA-09	Operations, Free-Tier Budget & Runbook	The zero-rupee ledger for three more front ends, alert thresholds, and eleven runbooks	Read this if you have a question about cost or about running the system.
AA-10	Manager Strategic Roadmap	Ten weeks, four engineers, the Gantt, the risk register and the ordered cut list	The schedule, the full risk register and the cut list. The companion to this document.
AA-11	Team Execution Handbook	One hundred and thirty numbered tasks with owners, steps and checkable outputs	The engineers doing the work, day to day.
AA-12	Management Summary	The programme in plain language, for readers who will not open the other twelve	This document.

One closing note on what this programme is not. It is not a redesign of the customer app, which is touched exactly once, and it is not a new product line. It is the removal of a specific constraint: that Atavishaala cannot take on another supplier or another delivery company without also taking on more of an employee. Whether that constraint has actually been removed is answered by the pilot in week ten and by the three measurements in section 12.5, and by nothing else.